

EDET200 ASSESSMENT 2: Rationale and plan for engaging learners, fostering positive behaviour, and managing challenging behaviour (1500-2000 words)

Introduction: Description of learning setting, learner characteristics and background, and approach to learner engagement and behaviour management

Learning Setting & Learner Characteristics and Background

Wattle High School is a co-educational NSW department of education secondary school located in Western Sydney. The school has 861 students (467 boys and 394 girls), with a 5% Indigenous population, and a 40% LBOTE population (ACARA, 2024). Its ICSEA value is 1016, with a fair distribution of students in the lower and middle socio-economic quarters. The school follows a strict SMART (Safe, Motivated, Academic, Respectful and Tolerant) behavioural policy, which guides the behaviour and learning of all students alongside the school vision of developing “problem solvers who understand that lifelong learning is the key to personal fulfilment” (ACARA, 2024). The specific selected classroom is a year 9 class, which contains a varied range of learner diversity, including EAL/D students, indigenous students, and students with Individualised Education Plans (IEPs). This classroom contains 2 students from an Indigenous background and 9 students with a language background other than English. Three specific students within this classroom have known diagnoses with IEPs, as well as 4 other students with identified behavioural struggles. Sophie is diagnosed with ADHD and Anxiety, she struggles with classroom focus and emotional regulation. Jacob is diagnosed with a mild intellectual disability and ASD level 1, he struggles to understand verbal instructions and is highly influenced by the misbehaviour of his peers. Sasha is diagnosed with Oppositional Defiant Disorder (ODD) and ADHD, however she also has a High Potential Development Plan (HPDP), she enjoys practical work and struggles with group activities, as well as a lack of clear, cohesive instruction.

Approach to learner engagement and behaviour management

My aim is to become a well-respected teacher, creating a classroom where students feel safe, comfortable, and able to speak freely. I want to create a classroom with clear instructional practice and a positive classroom culture fostering student learning. Effective classroom management begins with safety, shown through clear, displayed rules and expectations (Rogers, 2015). This aligns with the Positive Behaviour Support (PBS) model, where explicit modelling and clear expectations guide behaviour and encourage positive learning attitudes (NSW Department of Education, 2022). My approach is also based on Bandura’s Social Cognitive Theory, where the teacher models appropriate behaviours and helps students build self-efficacy (De Nobile et al., 2021). Furthermore, I believe misbehaviour has underlying causes that need to be addressed using strategies promoting engagement, understanding, and meeting student needs, reflecting values from the Responsible Thinking Process, wherein students are seen as critical within their own education. My aim is for their ideas to be part of the classroom culture so they feel represented and are encouraged to make respectful, positive choices (De Nobile et al., 2021).

All students bring unique identities, abilities, opinions, backgrounds, and attitudes to the classroom. I believe the classroom should be a safe environment where positive behaviours are modelled, supporting both academic and social growth. I endeavour to approach teaching with an open mind, modelling the skills and behaviours I wish to develop in my students, while remaining open to new learning opportunities.

Teacher actions / strategies	Theoretical frameworks / models; Legislative requirements and systems policies
<u>Preparatory and Establishment phases:</u> - Establishing an inclusive and collaborative classroom culture for supporting wellbeing and safety for diverse students. - Provision of inclusive learning opportunities and support for learners with diverse abilities and learning strengths and needs, including setting appropriate learning goals.	
- Seating arrangement → Students to be strategically seated in table groups of 4, encouraging collaboratively learning and positive modelling → Sophie, Jacob and Sasha to be placed on separate tables, with Sophie and Jacob at the front to minimise distractions. - Communication with other teachers - Classroom design → Minimise clutter and visual distractions → Clearly display school SMART policy and classroom rules - Providing provide unit outlines and clear school and classroom expectations to parents/carers	Positive Behaviour Support (PBS) Primary PBS Tier: Practical interventions, developing positive classroom culture and climate through clear expectations and a supportive environment. Students' external system is managed through strategic grouping and seating to reduce distractions and reinforce appropriate behaviours, minimising environmental triggers, to align with proactive PBS strategies (Simonsen & Myers, 2015) Social Cognitive Theory (SCT) Through developing classroom climate, positive modelling is enabled, encouraging observational learning and respectful participation (De Nobile, et al., 2021). Communication with parents/carers forms a respectful relationship, providing transparency and consistency between the students' environments. Responsible Thinking Process (RTP) RTP is reflected in the creation of seating arrangements, knowing the students and providing visual expectations. Selective seating groups enable effective peer modelling to emphasise students' behavioural autonomy whilst reducing distractions, creating opportunities for responsible choices (Ford, 2004). Policy and Legislation The SMART code, a whole-school policy, is adhered to at all times Student Behaviour Policy (NSW Department of Education, 2024a) - Proactive strategies and consistent management NSW Department of Education's inclusive education statement for students with a disability (2020) - Inclusive, supportive environments through external communication and visual behaviour displays.

Preparatory and Establishment phases:

- Preventative, non-punitive strategies, to develop a positive learning environment that supports student engagement in learning.
- Two examples of classroom activities and organisation, including communication strategies and explicit directions for the specific learning setting.

- Referring to expectations at the beginning of each lesson
- Transition timers
 - 5 minute timers for transitions to prepare students such as Sophie and Jacob for changes.
- Reinforce behaviour expectations during demonstrations and task explanations.
→ SMART awards
- Use of visual resources to enable engagement and understanding for EAL/D students and Sophie.

Activities Include:

- **Lesson Starter: 5-minute regulation timer**
 - Provides consistency within each lesson and allows Sophie to regulate her emotions at the beginning of the class.
 - Visually implemented on the smartboard to assist with understanding and transition preparation.
 - If class is disruptive, teacher can initiate a yarning circle where students share with classmates
- **Timber Robot Development**
 - The teacher provides clear communication on practical lesson expectations, demonstrates the steps and provides roaming support.
 - Students will be paired, but complete individual projects.
 - Allows Jacob to seek peer support to assist with understanding
 - Instruction booklet with images and written instructions provided, facilitating a range of learner types.
 - Avoids large group interactions and enables positive modelling.

Positive Behaviour Support (PBS)

Primary PBS Tier: Implementing proactive and preventative approaches for a positive classroom climate and culture (De Nobile, et al., 2021). Clear routines and expectations, as well as positive reinforcement address barriers to learning and engagement, targeting disengagement and misbehaviour before they occur (Simonsen & Sugai, 2019).

Social Cognitive Theory (SCT)

Positive reinforcement rewards students modelling appropriate behaviours, and improves self-efficacy. The regulation timer facilitates self-awareness and management through identification of emotions. Yarning circles allow for communication and empathy with peers, promoting self-efficacy and improving behaviour (De Nobile, et al., 2021).

Responsible Thinking Process (RTP)

These strategies prevent behavioural issues through repetitive rule reminders and predictable routines, allowing students to take responsibility for themselves. Pairing students within the robot development allows for respectful social dynamics, limiting negative peer modelling. Through this, critical peer learning opportunities are provided, a preventative strategy providing students with greater responsibility (Ford, 2004).

Policy and Legislation

The SMART code is adhered to at all times

NSW department of education wellbeing framework (2024b) - Pro-active, student-centered wellbeing and behaviour support strategies.

Child protection and duty of care requirements to develop safe, structured environments (NSW Department of Education, 2021).

Tier 1 interventions:

- Ethical, respectful, unobtrusive, non-punitive strategies for managing the classroom and responding to low-level undesired behaviours.

- Providing choices within instructions, or redirections, reduces oppositional behaviours, supporting Sasha.
- Non-verbal cues, proximity and prompts support student redirection and early behavioural intervention
- Consistent praise for students following the classroom expectations
- Ignoring undesired behaviours
- Process time and clarification time, to reduce barriers for EAL/D students and those with learning needs.
- SMART policy - Gentle rule reminder through questioning and redirection

Positive Behaviour Support (PBS)

Primary PBS tier: Preventative and inclusive strategies.

Proximity and gentle prompting guide students toward appropriate behaviour without escalation. This is supported by positive praise, maintaining clear expectations and encouraging desired behaviours (Simonsen & Sugai, 2019). Choices and non-verbal cues foster student autonomy and self-correction (Simonsen & Myers, 2015).

Social Cognitive Theory (SCT)

SCT is implemented through increased positive reinforcement for desired behaviours, alongside ignoring undesired behaviours. Non-verbal cues offer early intervention, teaching self-monitoring and emotional intelligence. The provision of choices aids students such as Sasha in achieving agency within their learning (De Nobile, et al., 2021).

Responsible Thinking Process (RTP)

This phase develops RTP values of student respect and responsibility. This is achieved through subtle redirection of distracted students, non-verbal cues, and student choices. RTP questioning is implemented through non-confrontational questions in alignment with the SMART code (De Nobile, et al., 2021).

Policy and Legislation

The SMART code is adhered to at all times

Disability standards for education (2005) (Department of Education, 2025) -
Adjustment of strategies to differentiate expectations and responses

NSW Student behaviour policy (2022) (NSW Department of Education, 2024a) -
Low-level early interventions prior to escalation

Teacher actions / strategies	Theoretical frameworks / models; Legislative requirements and systems policies
<u>Tier 2 interventions:</u> • Ethical and respectful strategies for responding to persistent undesired behaviours within the classroom.	
• Utilising an SLSO to withdraw the student from the over-stimulating environment. • Clear and immediate identification of misbehaviour and triggers through the Antecedent-Behaviour-Consequence approach • Respectful reminders of expectations and associated consequences • Separation of misbehaving groups to limit inappropriate peer modelling. • Management through effective questioning to redirect behaviour • Check in, Check out (CICO) cards to monitor and provide feedback on student behaviours • SMART procedure - first and second warning → Repeated behaviour initiates names written on whiteboard beside corresponding SMART letter, e.g. name written beside 'S' if student is being unsafe Communication with parents • Email sent to parents regarding misbehaviour and resulting consequences for students • Meeting with parents to develop appropriate, and consistent consequences to increase effectiveness.	Positive Behaviour Support (PBS) Secondary PBS tier: Immediate management and identification of triggers. The A-B-C approach identifies triggers for misbehaviour, monitoring patterns and enabling individualised interventions (De Nobile, et al., 2021). Implementing an SLSO allows for supportive intervention to reduce dysregulation and escalated behaviours. CICO cards allow for daily feedback and reflection, promoting self-monitoring and social-emotional learning (Simonsen & Myers, 2015). Social Cognitive Theory (SCT) The separation of students follows SCT values by reducing modelling of undesired behaviours, thereby reducing the 'reward'. Consistent communication between parents/carers maintains a cohesive environment and allows desirable behaviours to be modelled within all environments (De Nobile, et al., 2021). The A-B-C approach, and CICO cards highlight behavioural patterns and encourage students to make better choices, improving their self-efficacy. Responsible Thinking Process (RTP) Effective questioning is a strategy implemented that follows the RTP values, with the goal of making students aware of their misbehaviour, and guiding responsible choices through questions such as "What should you be doing?" (De Nobile, et al., 2021). Additionally, the visual use of the SMART reminders promotes self-monitoring and reflection, allowing students to correct their behaviour. Policy and Legislation The SMART code is adhered to at all times (First and Second stage) NSW student behaviour policy (2022)(NSW department of education, 2024a) - Individualised and preventative interventions Mandatory reporting and child protection policy (2023) - behavioural concerns are managed to prioritise student safety and wellbeing (NSW Inclusion and Wellbeing, 2023)

Tier 3 interventions: Managing Challenging Behaviour – More significant interventions:

- Practical strategies for managing challenging behaviour within the classroom

- Seek advice from senior executive team (year advisor, deputy principal, head teacher of learning and support)
- Providing student with a 'time out' to regulate emotions, and/or speak to a senior executive
- Conduct individualised, isolated conversation with Students to understand the nature of the behaviour
- SMART policy - third warning
 - Cross against students name to provide visual reiteration of consequence
 - Immediate classroom withdrawal or a detention to be issued

Positive Behaviour Support (PBS)

Tertiary PBS tier: Elevated strategies involving senior staff and classroom withdrawals. Including senior staff in the management process aligns with team-based PBS, offering collaborative support (Simonsen & Myers, 2015). Time-out passes, and individualised, isolated conversations allow for calm environments, where students are able to self-regulate (De Nobile, et al., 2021).

Social Cognitive Theory (SCT)

SCT is reflected through individualised conversations with misbehaving students, allowing an understanding of reasons behind inappropriate behaviours, such as low self-efficacy. Visual demonstration of warnings allow students to see the consequences, promoting self-monitoring whilst involving the student in the process, aiming for re-engagement in learning (Zimmerman, 2002).

Responsible Thinking Process (RTP)

By implementing a larger school approach, responsibility is extended beyond the classroom, following a cohesive RTP structure. The use of private conversations allows for reflection, supporting the belief that behaviour is communicative and can be redirected (De Nobile, et al., 2021).

Policy and Legislation

The SMART code is adhered to at all times (Third Stage)

NSW Student behaviour policy (2022) (NSW Department of Education, 2024a) - graduated responses to misbehaviour aiming for de-escalation.

Australian Student Wellbeing Framework (Student Wellbeing Hub, 2019) - student agency, consistent expectations and respectful relationships.

Tier 3 interventions: Managing Challenging Behaviour – moving beyond the classroom:

- Strategies for communicating sensitively and confidentially with parents/carers, and engaging with them throughout the process.
- The role of, and strategies for working with, professional colleagues, specialist teachers and/or school community liaison personnel to support Emergency responses.

- School and classroom guidelines shared with parents/carers
- Regular meetings to develop plans for students
- Regular collaboration with the Learning Support team for differentiation and support within the classroom
- Communicating with parents/carers regarding occurrences and consequences
- Involving educational and behavioural professionals
- SMART policy - third warning
 - Students to be sent immediately to the department Head teacher, or deputy principal for consequences.
 - Failure to attend detention results in escalation to a head teacher after school detention.
 - Parent/carers notified about after school detention

Positive Behaviour Support (PBS)

Secondary and Tertiary PBS tier: Management process.

Weekly check-ins build home-school partnerships, strengthening the team-based PBS model (Simonsen & Myers, 2015). The involvement of learning support and other professionals allow for differentiated interventions, following inclusive PBS practices (De Nobile, et al., 2021).

Social Cognitive Theory (SCT)

SCT is implemented through the communication of behavioural expectations to parents/carers, and whole school management creating consistency and positive role modelling within the student's systems. Support plans teach reflective thinking and social-emotional learning, assisting in self-management and behaviour adjustments (De Nobile, et al., 2021).

Responsible Thinking Process (RTP)

Involving parents/carers in the management process encourages shared responsibility and consistency. Behavioural plans support the RTP value that students are in control of their behaviour, and have the ability to change their behaviour when given appropriate support (De Nobile, et al., 2021).

Policy and Legislation

The SMART code is adhered to at all times (Third Stage)

Student Behaviour Policy (2022) (NSW Department of Education, 2024a) - More intensive, yet proportional responses, with a focus on communication with parents/carers.

NSW department of education wellbeing framework (2024b) - Strong collaboration with families to support behaviour and learning

Conclusion

My goal is to foster positive behaviour and follow effective policies and strategies for managing challenging behaviours. Setting up a classroom and implementing non-punitive strategies is key to developing a positive classroom climate to foster engagement; a major behavioural influence (Rogers, 2015). Through the consistent referral to classroom rules, preventative PBS strategies are used to develop a safe space, reducing misbehaviour. Upon presentation of misbehaviour, PBS has been implemented following the tiered framework, providing logical, clear consequences and management strategies. SCT is implemented through various forms of modelling from both the teacher, and other students in the classroom. Positive reinforcement and limiting attention given to undesired behaviours implements a perceived reward for positive behaviours (De Nobile, et al., 2021). Elements of RTP have been used to teach students the importance of controlling their own behaviours and taking responsibility for their learning. When combined, these elements develop a safe, supporting classroom environment to foster respectful, engaged student learning at all times.

Total Word Count: 1993

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